SECRETS OF GOOD HEALTH

For '90s action hero Suniel Shetty, fitness once meant building muscle and strength for the camera. Today, he says, it means something more enduring: staying healthy and active for his granddaughter. That personal shift mirrors a broader paradox shaping India's health conversation. Never before have people tracked their health so closely. Gym memberships are rising, supplements crowd store shelves and wellness retreats promise everything from detox to inner peace. Yet the country continues to grapple with rising lifestyle diseases. India is often described as the diabetes capital of the world, younger people are reporting heart attacks, stress has become almost a national condition.

It was against this backdrop that the discussion on wellness unfolded at the India Today conclave, bringing together voices from fitness, traditional healing and medical diagnostics to examine how the meaning of health itself is changing.

Wellness, Shetty argued, begins with consistency rather than complicated routines. His own approach remains simple: "You have to move, you have to exercise, you have to quantify your food and sleep. Nothing else matters." Equally important, he said, is learning to understand one's own body rather than blindly following wellness trends. "There is nothing called the celebrity diet," he said. Biomarkers, he noted, can help but are not definitive: they "give you a feel as to what suits you, what doesn't suit you. But not necessarily 100 per cent right".

The discussion then turned to traditional healing, with wellness entrepreneur Mira Kapoor highlighting the renewed interest in Ayurveda. Rather than viewing it in opposition to modern medicine, she argued that "it is about finding the right balance between wisdom and science", noting that contemporary diagnostics—from biomarkers to genetic tests—can offer increasingly precise insights into how the body functions.

At the same time, she cautioned against relying solely on laboratory numbers. "What we forget is to actually listen to what our body is telling us," Kapoor said, pointing to everyday signals such as poor sleep, acidity or fatigue. Ayurveda, she explained, encourages people "to look within" and respond accordingly. Kapoor also addressed the realities of urban life,



ATUL KUMAR YADAV

DR NAVIN DANG ▲
Chairman & Founder, Dr. Dangs Lab

In 24 hours, can't you even have one hour for yourself, for exercising, for meditating, for being away from this noise?

If we don't love ourselves, how will we love God? Look after your health...continue discipline

KEY TAKEAWAYS

- **Lifestyle diseases are rising in India, with diabetes already widespread and cardiovascular risk increasing**
- **Simple habits such as regular movement, mindful eating and proper sleep remain the most reliable path to long-term health**
- **People must understand how their own bodies respond to food, exercise, lifestyle choices instead of blindly copying popular trends**